

Component 3: Practical performance

Content

Students will be required to perform in one physical activity, in the role of either player/performer or coach. They will be required to demonstrate their skills while under pressure, in conditioned practice and a formal/competitive situation. Students must choose and perform one physical activity from the set list on pages 26 and 27.

Students should be taught to make relevant and appropriate links between their learning in Components 1 and 2 and use this to benefit their performances in the physical activities.

Students are required to demonstrate their ability to:

- perform a range of skills and techniques in physical activity
- make decisions, implement strategies, tactics and/or compositional ideas, and apply knowledge and understanding of rules and regulations while performing physical activity
- apply knowledge and understanding of theories, concepts, principles and methods to physical activity and performance.

General performance skills

Students should be aware of and apply appropriate and relevant physical attributes and psychological elements to the demands of their chosen activities.

Students must demonstrate appropriate levels of fitness in order to perform adequately.

Students must be aware of and apply appropriate and relevant rules/laws of the activity that they are performing. Students must perform their chosen activities safely. If they do not, then the teacher must intervene.

Physical activity list

The list below contains the permitted physical activities that students must select from. This list has been set by the Department for Education. Any changes or additions to the activities will in the first instance be indicated on our website. The rules in the right hand column provide further clarification as to the scope of a physical activity.

Physical activity	Rules
Acrobatic gymnastics*	
Amateur boxing	
Association football	Cannot be five-a-side.
Athletics	Can be assessed in one event from the disciplines of either Track or Field (including 5K and 10K track* and cross country*). Race walking is not a permitted Athletics event.
Badminton	
Basketball	Cannot be 'street basketball'.
BMX cycling*	Racing only, not tricks.
Canoeing	
Cricket	
Cycling	Track or road cycling.
Dance	Acceptable dances include: ballet, ballroom, contemporary/modern, cultural (includes hip-hop, Irish, Indian, jazz, Latin), folk and street.
Diving	Platform diving.
Equestrian	Can be assessed in either show jumping, cross country or dressage.
Field hockey	
Figure skating*	Men's and ladies' singles or team.
Futsal*	
Gaelic football	
Golf	
Gymnastics	Floor routines and apparatus.
Handball	
Hurling	
Ice hockey*	
Inline Roller hockey*	
Kayaking	
Lacrosse	
Netball	
Rock climbing	Can be indoor or outdoor.

Physical activity	Rules
Rowing	
Rugby league	Cannot be tag rugby.
Rugby union	Can be assessed as sevens or fifteen a side. Cannot be tag rugby.
Sailing*	Crew-based events or single-handed dinghy. Royal Yachting Association recognised sailing-boat classes only. Students must perform as helmsman.
Sculling	Team* or singles.
Skiing	Outdoor/indoor on snow. Must not be on dry slopes.
Snowboarding	Outdoor/indoor on snow. Must not be on dry slopes.
Squash	
Swimming	Not synchronised swimming.
Table tennis	
Tennis	
Trampolining	
Triathlon*	Sprint only.
Volleyball	
Water polo*	
Windsurfing*	
Specialist physical activity**	Rules
Blind cricket	
Boccia	
Goalball	
Powerchair football	
Polybat	
Table cricket	
Wheelchair basketball	
Wheelchair rugby	

* These activities are available for first teaching from September 2020 and first certification from Summer 2022.

** The specialist activities are available only to those students with a physical disability, and in line with entry criteria set out by that activity's National Governing Body. If a student is classified as eligible, then they should be assessed in the classification based on the relevant activity's National Governing Body classification criteria.

Assessment information

- First assessment: May/June 2018.
- It is recommended that the minimum duration for the student activity is approximately 54 hours, combining preparation and the assessed performance.
- The assessment is out of 40 marks.
- Marks must be submitted at the end of the course.
- The assessment will be internally marked by the centre and externally moderated by Pearson.
- The assessment consists of students completing one physical activity from the set list on pages 26–27 of this specification.
- Students can be assessed in either the role of player/performer or coach.
- As a player/performer, students will be assessed against set assessment criteria which can be found in the *Practical Performance Assessment Criteria*. There are separate assessment criteria for each physical activity. Generic assessment criteria are on pages 31–35 of this specification.
- As a coach, students will be assessed against set assessment criteria which can be found on pages 36–41 of this specification and in the *Practical Performance Assessment Criteria*.
- Centres must ensure that marks for each performance submitted are valid for the series in which they are submitted.
- The activities with a single asterisk in the set list of physical activities on pages 26–27 of this specification are available for first teaching from September 2020 and first certification from Summer 2022.

Practical performance setting

Students should choose their physical activity with the support and advice of their teacher.

Assessing the physical activities

Teachers must design physical activities to enable all students to demonstrate their skills and techniques in order to meet the assessment criteria. Formal/competitive activities are defined as, for example and where appropriate, performances in a full-sided game and performances in front of an audience/judges. If students are participating in a team game then a full-sided game must be demonstrated in the assessment of the activity. Where it becomes apparent to the teacher assessing that students are not being given the opportunity to demonstrate their full range of skills during a formal/competitive game situation, the teacher may intervene to create an opportunity for a conditioned practice (for example by permitting defenders to switch sides) to allow students to demonstrate their appropriate skills. This condition applies predominately to team game activities (such as football, rugby union, rugby league, hockey, lacrosse, basketball, camogie, hurling, handball, netball, volleyball) but may also apply to other activities where necessary.

It is recommended that the minimum duration for the student activity is approximately 54 hours, combining preparation and the assessed performance.

The ideal model would be for this time to be a block, with one activity being followed, leading up to the assessed performance. Acceptable alternatives include intensive teaching programmes. The duration of assessed performances in each physical activity should be based on appropriate timings to allow students to demonstrate the requirements of a player/performer or coach in the selected physical activity. For example, the duration of competitive situations will differ for each selected physical activity.

Formal assessment of the physical activity may take place at any point during the course.

Practical performance preparation

Teaching and learning

To help students choose a physical activity, teachers should cover the following key points:

- the role of the player/performer or coach in their chosen physical activity
- how they can develop the skills, techniques and attributes to perform successfully in their chosen physical activity
- the rules and laws of their chosen physical activity.

Resources

Students should have access to a range of resources/equipment to enable them to meet the practical demands of their chosen physical activity. Resources and equipment used should follow governing body guidelines/rules, for example ESAA (English Schools Athletics Association) rules for athletics events.

Practical performance taking

Students must choose and perform one physical activity from the set list in the role of player/performer or coach.

Authenticity and Collaboration

Students and teachers must sign the *Practical performance authentication sheet*, please see *Appendix 1*. This is to ensure that the practical performance is the student's own work.

Feedback

Teacher support is a permitted, and important, part of the preparation for the assessed practical performance. Teachers can help students to understand rules/laws of the activities and the assessment criteria. However, feedback is not permitted in the assessed practical performance, unless it is required for health and safety reasons, for example to reduce the risk of injury. During the assessed practical performance teachers are not allowed to coach their students. Any additional feedback must be recorded on the *Practical performance authentication sheet*, please see *Appendix 1*.

Time control

It is suggested that the minimum duration for each student activity is approximately 54 hours, combining preparation and the assessed performance.

The duration of assessed performances in each activity should be based on an appropriate time to allow students to demonstrate the requirements of a player/performer in the selected physical activity, for example the duration of competitive situations will differ for each selected physical activity.

Formal assessments of activities may take place at any point during the course.

Safety

All activities submitted will need to comply with all the appropriate recommendations related to the safety of students as recognised by the Association for Physical Education in their publication, *Safe Practice in Physical Education & School Sport 2012*.

Practical performance marking, standardisation and moderation

Teachers should mark the practical performances of students in the role of player/performer using the assessment criteria in the *Practical performance assessment criteria*. There are separate assessment criteria for each physical activity. These document is found on the Pearson website. Generic assessment criteria can be found on pages 31–35 of this specification.

Teachers should mark the practical performances of students in the role of coach using the assessment criteria on pages 36–41 of this specification. These assessment criteria can also be found in the *Practical performance assessment criteria*.

Teachers should include any comments on the *Practical performance authentication sheet* in *Appendix 1* to justify the marks awarded.

Where marking has been carried out by more than one teacher in a centre, there must be a process of internal standardisation carried out to ensure that there is a consistent application of the assessment criteria.

Marks awarded by the centre will be subject to external moderation by Pearson. Moderation will ensure consistency with national standards and will include a review of marking to ensure that the rules have been correctly applied by centres. Pearson/moderators, in consultation with the centre, will select a representative sample of students of different abilities, and in a range of activities, and taking cohort size into account. For activities that cannot be assessed live on moderation day, centres must video record the evidence of the assessment. This evidence will be used to support the marks awarded and must be provided if requested by Pearson for moderation purposes.

If the moderation indicates that centre assessment does not reflect national standards, an adjustment will be made to students' final marks to compensate for this.

For further information please refer to the Joint Council for Qualifications (JCQ) document *Instructions for conducting non-examination assessments (new GCE and GCSE specifications)* on the JCQ website: www.jcq.org.uk. The assessment of this qualification must comply with these instructions.

Videoing practical performances on moderation day

Centres must video the students in the sample on moderation day. This is to support an EAR, if requested. Centres that do not record on moderation day cannot request an EAR. Please see *Appendix 5: Recording practical performances*, pages 82–86 for full advice and guidance. Centres must submit to Pearson the video evidence collected on moderation day.

Practical performance generic assessment criteria: player/performer

The following is generic assessment criteria, explaining the standard expected at each level for a player/performer.

The assessment criteria for each specific physical activity can be found on our website in the *Pearson Edexcel Level 3 Advanced GCE in Physical Education Practical performance assessment criteria*. The criteria should be used to mark each student's performance.

Skills/Content

Students will be assessed on the quality of appropriate skills, techniques and decision making processes under pressure, to meet the challenges of conditioned practice and a formal/competitive situation.

Level	Marks	Guidance	Description
	0		No rewardable evidence
1	1–8	(1–4 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level.	Demonstrates a basic level of performance. Skills, techniques and decision making are characterised by little precision, control and fluency, during a formal/competitive situation. • Position-specific skills and techniques performed to a basic level. • Skills and techniques performed to a basic level. • Basic influence on performance and motivation of self and others. • Any tactical changes are ineffectively applied in response to the opposition's actions, with multiple misjudgements. • Attempts to adapt to changes in a competitive situation to dominate opponents but with little success.
		(5–8 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level and may sometimes exceed expectations.	

Level	Marks	Guidance	Description
2	9–16	(9–12 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level.	Demonstrates a competent level of performance. Skills, techniques and decision making are characterised by some precision, control and fluency, during a formal/competitive situation. • Position-specific skills and techniques performed to a competent level. • Skills and techniques performed to a competent level. • Competent influence on performance and motivation of self and others. • Tactical changes are sometimes effectively applied in response to the opposition's actions but with misjudgements. • Attempts to adapt to changes in a competitive situation to dominate opponents with some success.
		(13–16 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level and may sometimes exceed expectations.	

Level	Marks	Guidance	Description
3	17–24	(17–20 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level.	Demonstrates a good level of performance. Skills, techniques and decision making are characterised by good precision, control and fluency, during a formal/competitive situation. • Position-specific skills and techniques performed to a good level. • Skills and techniques performed to a good level. • Good influence on performance and motivation of self and others. • Tactical changes are effective in response to the opposition's actions but with minor misjudgements. • Adapts effectively to changes in a competitive situation to dominate opponents with a good level of success.
		(21–24 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level and may sometimes exceed expectations.	

Level	Marks	Guidance	Description
4	25–32	(25–28 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level.	Demonstrates a very good level of performance. Skills, techniques and decision making are characterised by very good precision, control and fluency, during a formal/competitive situation. • Position-specific skills and techniques performed to a very good level. • Skills and techniques performed to a very good level. • Very good influence on performance and motivation of self and others. • Applies tactical changes effectively in response to the opposition's actions with few, if any, misjudgements. • Adapts effectively to changes in a competitive situation to dominate opponents with a very good level of success.
		(29–32 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level and may sometimes exceed expectations.	

Level	Marks	Guidance	Description
5	33–40	(33–36 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level.	Demonstrates an outstanding level of performance. Skills, techniques and decision making are characterised by outstanding precision, control and fluency, during a formal/competitive situation. • Position-specific skills and techniques performed to an outstanding level. • Skills and techniques performed to an outstanding level. • Outstanding influence on performance and motivation of self and others. • Applies tactical changes highly effectively in response to the opposition's actions without misjudgements. • Adapts highly effectively to changes in a competitive situation to dominate opponents with an outstanding level of success.
		(37–40 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level and may sometimes exceed expectations.	

Where it becomes apparent to the assessor that students are not being given the opportunity to demonstrate their full range of skills during a game situation, assessors may intervene to create an opportunity (for example permitting defenders to switch sides) to allow students to demonstrate their appropriate skills. This is to guarantee that all students have the opportunity to demonstrate their skills and decision making because in a competitive game, for example football, it may be that a defender never gets to touch the ball through no fault of their own but because of how the game has evolved. Therefore, giving the player/performer the opportunity to demonstrate appropriate skills in a formal/competitive situation is necessary so that relevant and legitimate marks may be awarded.

Practical performance assessment criteria: coach

The following is assessment criteria for the coach. It can be applied to the assessment of the coach in all of the physical activities in the set list.

Skills/Content

Students will be assessed on their ability to coach effectively through the planning, organisation and delivery of coaching sessions to an individual, group or team while under observation in conditioned practice and a formal/competitive situation:

- judgement of the authority shown by the coach
- sport/activity specific knowledge (of laws, techniques, safeguarding and regulations)
- strategy/planning/aim
- organisation (logistics, planning, health and safety, risk management)
- motivation/inspiration/empathy with individual, group or team
- performance of coaching in a formal/competitive situation – ability to communicate, adapt, and refine – their coaching style and strategies to meet their aim(s)
- analysis and evaluation – feedback and guidance before, during and after the formal/competitive situation, reflecting potential changes in strategy
- use of appropriate physical characteristics/attributes to benefit their own performance
- demonstrate psychological control (e.g. anxiety, arousal, aggression).

Level	Marks	Guidance	Description
	0		No rewardable evidence.
1	1–8	(1–4 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level.	The coach has demonstrated little authority in the planning, organisation, delivery and evaluation of their coaching when under the demands of a formal/competitive performance with an individual, group or team. • Inappropriate and little organisation, with no clear or relevant aim(s), failing to utilise SMART(ER) principles, with inappropriate coaching not relevant to the skill, abilities and fitness of the individual, group or team. • Unclear and convoluted coaching delivery, reflecting a lack of sport/activity-specific knowledge. • Ineffective adaptations of communication and coaching style, reflecting a lack of empathy in meeting the needs of the individual, group or team through the use of voice, gesture and/or demonstration. • Responding poorly and inappropriately to changing formal/competitive situation and/or external conditions. • The feedback and guidance (based on poor quality interpretation of performance data and/or observation) when given is inaccurate, lacks support for and not targeted to needs of the individual, group or team. • Self-reflection demonstrates limited consideration of the areas for personal improvement as a coach.
		(5–8 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level and may sometimes exceed expectations.	

Level	Marks	Guidance	Description
2	9–16	(9–12 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level.	The coach has demonstrated limited authority in the planning, organisation, delivery and evaluation of their coaching when under the demands of a formal/competitive performance with an individual, group or team. • Some evidence of appropriate and structured organisation, with a defined aim(s), a limited use of SMART(ER) principles, with emerging coaching relevant to the skill, abilities and fitness of an individual, group or team. • The level of coaching delivery, reflects some simplistic sport/activity-specific knowledge. • Adaptations of communication and coaching structure/methods support in part with emerging empathy the needs of the individual, group or team seen through the occasional appropriate use of voice, gesture and/or demonstration, responding with occasional flexibility and corrections to a changing formal/competitive situation and/or external conditions. • Attempts to respond to changing formal/competitive situation and/or external conditions with limited success. • The feedback and guidance is mainly uninformative (based on a simplistic interpretation of performance data and/or observation) and when given only occasionally meets the needs of the individual, group or team. • Self-reflection demonstrates some relevant insight when considering of the areas for personal improvement as a coach.
		(13–16 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level and may sometimes exceed expectations.	

Level	Marks	Guidance	Description
3	17–24	(17–20 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level.	The coach has demonstrated an emerging level of authority in the planning, organisation, delivery and evaluation of their coaching when under the demands of a formal/competitive performance with an individual, group or team. • Invariably appropriate and structured organisation, with a defined aim(s), based in part on the full use of SMART(ER) principles, with observations of appropriate coaching relevant to the skill, abilities and fitness of the individual, group or team. • Reliable quality coaching delivery, reflecting a developing sport/activity-specific knowledge. • Increasing and more effective adaptations of communication and coaching style, showing appropriate empathy to meet the needs of the individual, group or team seen through the developing use of voice, gesture and/or demonstration. • Responses show signs of flexibility to the changing formal/competitive situation and/or external conditions. • The feedback and guidance (based on some accurate interpretation of performance data and/or observation) when given can be relevant and targeted to needs of the individual, group or team. • Self-reflection demonstrates a more secure insight into the areas for personal improvement as a coach.
		(21–24 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level and may sometimes exceed expectations.	

Level	Marks	Guidance	Description
4	25–32	(25–28 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level.	The coach has demonstrated a secure level of authority in the planning, organisation, delivery and evaluation of their coaching when under the demands of a formal/competitive performance with an individual, group or team. • Appropriate and structured organisation, with a defined aim(s), effectively using SMART(ER) principles, with appropriate coaching relevant to the skill, abilities and fitness of the individual, group or team, with occasional errors. • Sessions reflect clear, concise, and increasingly effective coaching delivery, reflecting a more detailed range of sport/activity-specific knowledge and an invariable ability to manage the coaching environment. • Evidence of effective adaptations of communication and coaching style, showing appropriate empathy to meet the needs of the individual, group or team, with few, if any, errors in the use of voice, gesture, and/or demonstration. • Responses to changing formal/competitive situation and/or external conditions are flexible and correct with only minor misjudgements. • The feedback and guidance (based on accurate interpretation of performance data and/or observation) given is accurate, relevant and targeted to needs of the individual, group or team, with only few minor misjudgements, and the use of coaching aids, e.g. video, may be employed. • Self-reflection demonstrates informative considerations of the areas for personal improvement as a coach.
		(29–32 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level and may sometimes exceed expectations.	

Level	Marks	Guidance	Description
5	33–40	(33–36 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level.	The coach has demonstrated an assured level authority in the planning, organisation, delivery and evaluation of their coaching when under the demands of a formal/competitive performance with an individual, group or team. • Appropriate and structured organisation, with a clearly defined aim(s), fully utilising SMART(ER) principles, with appropriate coaching relevant to the skill, abilities and fitness of the individual, group or team. • Clear, concise, and effective coaching delivery, reflecting a thorough sport/activity-specific knowledge and a mature ability to manage the coaching environment. • Effective and enhancing adaptations of communication and coaching style, showing appropriate empathy to meet the needs of the individual, group or team seen through the effective use of voice, gesture and/or demonstration. • Responding flexibly and correctly to changing formal/competitive situation and/or external conditions. • The feedback and guidance (based on accurate interpretation of performance data and/or observation) given is insightful, relevant and targeted to needs of the individual, group or team, and the use of coaching aids, e.g. video, may be employed. • Self-reflection demonstrates critical and insightful considerations of the areas for personal improvement as a coach.
		(37–40 marks) Performance meets all requirements of this level and may sometimes exceed expectations.	